

How to Run These Notebooks Locally

A step-by-step guide to downloading lecture files and running interactive Julia Pluto notebooks.

Follow these simple steps to download the lecture files and open the interactive notebooks on your own computer.

Step 1: Download the “Lectures” Folder

Because each notebook relies on image figures and support files, you need to download the entire **Lectures** folder rather than just a single `.jl` file.

1. Go to our repository by clicking the **GitHub logo (cat)** in the top-left corner.
2. Click the green **Code** button near the top right of the page.
3. Select **Download ZIP** to save the file to your computer.

Step 2: Unzip the Downloaded File

A `.zip` file compresses multiple files into a single bundle to make downloading faster. You must extract (unzip) it before using the files inside:

Windows:

1. Open your **Downloads** folder.
2. Right-click the `.zip` file you just downloaded (usually named `MeasuringLiveSite-main.zip`).
3. Select **Extract All...** from the menu.
4. Click **Extract** in the window that pops up. This creates a regular, unzipped folder with the same name.

Mac:

1. Open your **Downloads** folder in **Finder**.
2. Double-click the `.zip` file (usually named `MeasuringLiveSite-main.zip`).
3. Mac will automatically extract it into a normal folder named `MeasuringLiveSite-main`.

Tip: Remember where this extracted folder is located (by default, it will be in your **Downloads** folder).

Step 3: Open the Terminal Window

The **Terminal** (or Command Prompt) is a text-based window where you can type direct commands to your computer instead of using a mouse.

Mac:

1. Press `Cmd + Space` on your keyboard to open Spotlight search.
2. Type **Terminal**.
3. Press **Enter**. A black or white window with text will open—this is your terminal window.

Windows:

1. Press the **Windows Key** on your keyboard.
2. Type **Command Prompt** (or **PowerShell**).
3. Press **Enter**. A black window with a blinking cursor will open—this is your terminal window.

Step 4: Launch Pluto

1. In your open terminal window, type `julia` and press **Enter** to start the Julia programming language:

```
julia
```

2. Start the Pluto application by typing these two lines (press **Enter** after each line):

```
using Pluto  
Pluto.run()
```

3. A browser tab will automatically open displaying the **Pluto dashboard**.

Step 5: Open Your Notebook

1. In the Pluto dashboard, locate the **Open a notebook** section.
2. Under **Open from file**, click **Browse...**
3. Navigate to where you saved the downloaded folder on your computer. Go into:

```
Downloads / MeasuringLiveSite-main / Lectures / [Selected Lecture Folder]
```

4. Open the folder for whichever lecture you are interested in.
5. Select the file ending in `.jl`. Note that the lecture folders show the full name, while the `.jl` files often have abbreviated titles (for example, a folder named `GrilichesDataWoes` may contain `GDW.jl`).
6. Click **Run notebook code**.

Note on First-Time Loading: Pluto automatically installs any required packages the first time you open a notebook. This may take a few minutes, but it only happens once!